



DEALER BEST PRACTICE SERIES

Dealer Fabricated Tool Management

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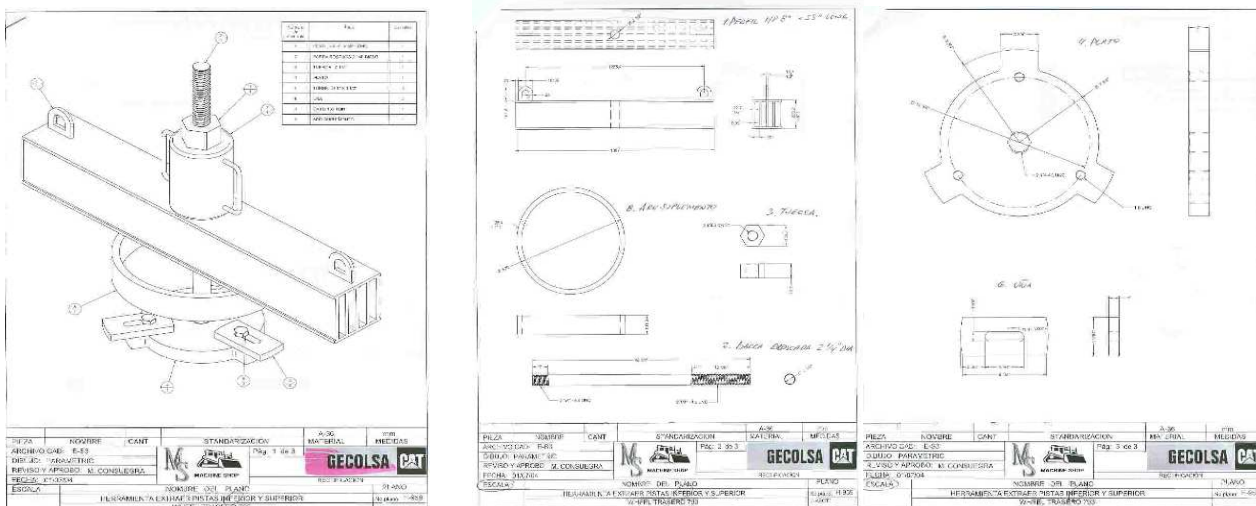
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Dealers design and fabricate many tools used in the service department, on service vehicles, and on jobsites. Fabricated tooling and equipment typically includes workbenches, rebuild stands, material handling equipment, parts cleaning and staging baskets, and many specialty tools. Often, fabricated tools are created without a formal process to design or manufacture the tool, or to maintain, track, repair, or replace the tool if lost or damaged. This Best Practice discusses a fabricated tooling management process.

Proper tooling is important for rebuild quality and labor efficiency. Whether the tool is a purchased tool or a fabricated tool, the impact is the same if the tool is not available when needed.

- Practice that all fabricated tools have an engineering-quality blueprint on file with design dimensions and specifications as well as any purchased part numbers and suppliers identified.
- Fabricated tool engineering blueprints are stored in a database by SCMS code for easy search if needed. Engineering blueprints are usually stored electronically in a PDF format.
- Any maintenance that the tool may require is defined in the design blueprint. Maintenance is tracked through the normal tooling PM processes.
- Some dealers also record cost in time and materials to fabricate the tool.



3.0 Implementation Steps

- Develop an engineering drawing for any tool developed in house. Drawing needs to include:
 - Accurate dimensions of the tool.
 - Type and specification of materials used to make the tool.
 - Construction process – such as weld locations and specification.
 - Any parts utilized to make the tool with part number and supplier identified.
 - Calibration requirements is needed
 - Maintenance requirements if needed
 - Usage of tool – SCMS code.
 - Cost to construct the tool (optional)
- Create a database archive for the fabricated tool records.
- Assign responsibilities and ownership for tool design and drawings.
- Assign responsibilities and ownership for keeping database current.

4.0 Benefits

- Complete information on a tool makes it easy to repair, replace, or duplicate.
- Easy to share fabricated tool design information with other branches. Creates a commonality among all dealer branches and reduces need to redesign.
- Makes “mass production” of the tooling easier (i.e.: workbenches, parts baskets, stands, etc)

5.0 Resources Required

Time required to implement.

6.0 Supporting Attachments / References

None.

7.0 Related Best Practices

None.

8.0 Acknowledgements

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